

Ocean Freight Typical Transit Times — Selected Major Lanes

Internal sourcing-desk reference. Synthetic estimates prepared for the Commerce Agent Bench dataset; not a carrier-published timetable. Use carrier-specific quotes for booked vessels.

1. How to read these numbers

Each row gives a typical port-to-port (gate-to-gate) transit window for full ocean freight on the named lane. The range reflects the typical band across major carriers, seasons, and routings; actual vessel-specific transit can be 1–4 days longer than the upper bound when transshipment ports are congested or when a vessel is held for berthing windows. Numbers do not include inland transit from origin factory to loading port, customs clearance at destination, or final delivery to the consignee's warehouse.

Transit estimates substantially shorter than the lane's typical band usually indicate the buyer is confusing sea freight with air, mis-remembering an earlier quote, or thinking of one expedited LCL consolidator's service. Verify directly with the buyer before basing a delivery commitment on an outlier-fast ocean estimate.

2. Major lanes — origin China to North America

Origin	Destination	Typical transit (days)	Notes
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Long Beach (USLAX)	14–18	TPEB Pacific eastbound, no transshipment
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Los Angeles (USLAX)	14–18	Same lane group
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Oakland (USOAK)	14–18	TPEB Pacific eastbound
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Seattle / Tacoma (USSEA / USTAC)	13–17	Slightly faster than LA / LB
Shanghai (CNSHA)	New York / Newark (USNYC)	28–35	Via Panama Canal
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Savannah (USSAV)	28–34	Via Panama Canal
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Manzanillo / Lázaro Cárdenas (MX, Pacific)	18–25	TPEB Pacific eastbound
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Veracruz (MXVER)	30–38	Atlantic Mexico via Panama Canal
Yantian (CNYTN)	Long Beach (USLAX)	13–17	Slightly faster than Shanghai origin
Ningbo (CNNGB)	Long Beach (USLAX)	14–18	Same lane group as Shanghai origin

3. Major lanes — origin China to Europe

Origin	Destination	Typical transit (days)	Notes
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Hamburg (DEHAM)	30–38	Via Suez Canal
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Felixstowe (GBFXT)	30–38	Same lane group
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Rotterdam (NLRTM)	30–37	Via Suez Canal
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Antwerp (BEANR)	30–38	Via Suez Canal
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Le Havre (FRLEH)	30–37	Via Suez Canal
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Genoa (ITGOA)	26–32	Mediterranean — shorter via Suez
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Piraeus (GRPIR)	24–30	Mediterranean transshipment hub
Ningbo (CNNGB)	Hamburg (DEHAM)	30–38	Same lane group as Shanghai origin

4. Major lanes — origin China to rest of world

Origin	Destination	Typical transit (days)	Notes
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Santos (BRSSZ)	30–40	South America Atlantic; may transship at a Caribbean hub

Origin	Destination	Typical transit (days)	Notes
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Buenos Aires (ARBUE)	32–42	South America Atlantic via Cape of Good Hope or Panama
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Valparaíso (CLVAP)	28–36	South America Pacific
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Jebel Ali (AEJEA)	18–25	Via Singapore transshipment
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Sydney (AUSYD)	18–22	Direct or via Singapore
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Melbourne (AUMEL)	18–22	Same lane group as Sydney
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Durban (ZADUR)	28–35	South Africa east coast
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Cape Town (ZACPT)	30–38	South Africa west coast
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Tokyo (JPTYO)	3–5	Short-haul intra-Asia
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Yokohama (JPYOK)	3–5	Intra-Asia
Shanghai (CNSHA)	Ho Chi Minh City (VNSGN)	5–9	Intra-Asia, often via Hong Kong

5. Air freight (for comparison)

Direct-flight air freight from Shanghai PVG to any major hub (DXB / FRA / JFK / LAX / SYD / GRU) is typically 3–7 days door-to-door including customs clearance. Air freight is the only realistic option for transit times shorter than the lower bound of the ocean lane. Air costs roughly 7–12× the ocean rate per kilogram of cargo and is therefore reserved for high-value, urgent or perishable shipments.